

No. 6 Who Really Rules the World?

PLEASE NOTE: This talk includes a video

JESUS REVEALED WHO REALLY RULES THE WORLD (5 min.)

The Bible reveals a key reason why human governments cannot solve the problems we see today

Let us consider what we can learn from a conversation that took place shortly after Jesus' baptism **[Read Luke 4:5-8]**

Satan offered Jesus "all the kingdoms of the inhabited earth"

Satan acknowledged that such authority had "been handed over" to him (w15 11/15 17 ¶4)

Jesus later referred to Satan as "the ruler of the world" (Joh 14:30; 16:11)

Satan's wicked influence over the earth explains why mankind's problems persist (1Jo 5:19)

Let us discuss three questions related to Satan's rulership of this world:

- (1) How does Satan use his authority?
- (2) How should we view human governments?
- (3) How can we carry on our pure worship while living in Satan's world?

HOW DOES SATAN USE HIS AUTHORITY? (5 min.)

Satan uses his authority to influence people's thinking and conduct (Eph 2:2)

He promotes the lie that humans can successfully rule themselves (c/ 121 ¶9-10)

His personality is often reflected in the way human governments rule (Re 12:9, 12; 13:2; w04 4/1 4 ¶7)

However, the Bible does not say that Satan directly controls each leader or official

Satan uses governments to draw people away from worshipping Jehovah

Satan offered Jesus control of the governments in exchange for "an act of worship" (Mt 4:9)

Satan promotes worshipful allegiance to beastlike governments (Re 13:4)

How should knowing these truths affect our view of human governments?

HOW SHOULD WE VIEW HUMAN GOVERNMENTS? (5 min.)

Some human rulers exercise their authority conscientiously (Ac 13:7, 12)

Some governments have even supported God's people (Re 12:16; w22.05 6 ¶17)

We recognize that Jehovah allows governments to exist and to have a measure of authority over human society **[Read Romans 13:1]** (w22.10 14 ¶6)

Jehovah expects us to obey secular authorities and to pay our taxes (Ro 13:2, 5-7)

He directs us to speak about and treat rulers with respect (Tit 3:1, 2)

When we obey the secular authorities, we please Jehovah and we benefit ourselves and others (Ro 13:4; w23.10 9 ¶13)

HOW CAN WE CARRY ON OUR WORSHIP WHILE LIVING IN SATAN'S WORLD? (7 min.)

In imitation of Jesus, we worship only Jehovah

Consider two principles Jesus taught that can guide us today

These two principles can help us to decide whether the *services* we are asked to perform, the *ceremonies* we are asked to participate in, the *clothes* we are asked to wear, or the *salutations* that we are expected to offer would compromise our worship of Jehovah

First, Jesus taught that we must “pay back Caesar’s things to Caesar, but God’s things to God”
[Read Mark 12:17]

We must determine whether Caesar is asking something of us that rightfully belongs to God
Jehovah deserves our wholehearted devotion (Re 4:11)

We belong to Jehovah and devote our life to him alone (Ro 14:8; w02 11/1 15 ¶4)

We are careful not to render worshipful devotion to anyone but Jehovah (1Jo 5:21)

When a conflict arises between what Caesar demands and what God requires, we “obey God as ruler rather than men” (Ac 5:29)

Second, Jesus taught that his Kingdom “is no part of this world” **[Read John 18:36]**

We avoid any activity, including employment, that violates our neutral stand toward human governments

We do not learn war or take up arms against others (Isa 2:4)

We remain “no part of the world” and do not get involved in politics (Joh 15:19)

We do not take sides in debates about social, moral, or political issues

We choose to follow Bible principles, while we respect the choices others make

In the following video, note how Jehovah’s Witnesses, both young and old, have rendered pure worship to Jehovah no matter what form of government they live under

VIDEO (6 min.)

BE DETERMINED TO WORSHIP ONLY JEHOVAH (1 min.)

The example of Jehovah’s Witnesses demonstrates that it is possible to render pure worship in a world ruled by Satan

Jesus foretold that Satan would “be cast out,” expelled from his position as ruler of this world (Joh 12:31)

Until then, let us imitate Jesus and be determined to render sacred service to Jehovah alone!

TO BE COVERED IN 29 MINUTES

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